Oct 18th, 2026 Editor: Advaith K High: 60°F Low: 36°F

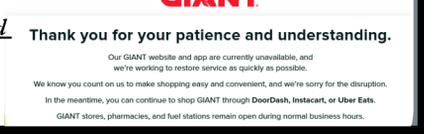
News Weekly

Giant website down as company faces security issue

GIANT grocery stores across the region remain open for business, however, the chain's website and app are both down -- and have been for days -- due to a cyberattack, according to company officials.

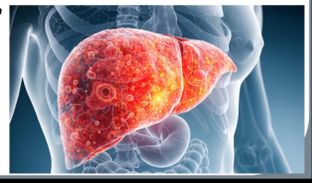
As of Thursday morning, a visit to the website for the grocery chain was met with a static image noting that the app and website are down and any orders placed through them both would be refunded. Delivery orders could still be placed through Instacart, DoorDash, and Uber Eats, however. Officials with the company said that GIANT stores, pharmacies, and fuel stations remain open during normal business hours.

But, on Monday, the company that owns GIANT, Ahold Delhaize, released a statement noting that it was "experiencing a security issue within its network." Our teams are taking steps to assess and mitigate the issue. This resulted in us taking precautionary measures, including taking some systems offline to help protect them," the company said in an updated statement on Tuesday. (NBC)



Eating late at night linked to up to 30% higher risk of liver disease

Late-night snacking may have more consequences than just extra calories; it could significantly affect liver health. A study by Oregon Health & Science University (OHSU) found that eating late increases the risk of liver diseases like fatty liver disease and cirrhosis by 20% to 30%. This research, published in Clinical Gastroenterology and Hepatology, used data from nearly 200,000 participants and revealed a consistent link between late eating and liver disease. The liver's sensitivity to circadian rhythms, which regulate many bodily functions, may explain this connection. Eating during times when the body is winding down for sleep can disrupt metabolic processes, potentially leading to liver issues. This discovery opens up the possibility that adjusting meal timing could improve liver health without needing drastic dietary changes. (Science Daily)



Green, cyan and red: astronomers reveal the surprising true colours of white dwarf stars

White dwarfs, remnants of Sun-like stars, were traditionally believed to glow in basic colors like white, and blue, corresponding to their temperatures. However, recent research by the University of Warwick shows that these dense stars can display a surprising range of colors, such as green, pink, cyan, yellow,red, and purple. This unexpected color variation arises from the extreme density of white dwarf atmospheres, where trace elements interact with dense helium plasma, altering the star's color. For example, the star WD J1330+6435 exhibits a chartreuse green hue due to calcium, lithium, and sodium in its atmosphere, an unprecedented color among stars. At the other end,WD J1011+2845 is a deep salmon-pink. Despite this diversity, most white dwarfs still appear white, with a median color temperature of 6,800 Kelvin, correcting the misconception that they are predominantly blue. This study highlights how much a star's spectrum can reveal, not just about its chemical composition and temperature, but also its true color.(University of Warwick)



Man searching with metal detector unearths massive Viking Age fortune, shattering records

The recent discovery of a Viking Age silver hoard near Sysmä, Finland, is a groundbreaking archaeological find. Unearthed by metal detectorist Kalle Lappinen, the hoard includes over 4,000 coins and weighs about 10 pounds, dating back to 1000-1050 A.D. This discovery, supervised by archaeologist Esko Tikkala, outnumbers Finland's previous largest find and highlights Sysmä's historical significance as a trade hub. Researchers are eager to understand the silver economy of the era, with the hoard offering insights into trade connections across Europe and the Middle East. While the original owner's identity and reasons for burying the treasure remain speculative, the dual deposits of the hoard add a new dimension to Viking Age studies in Finland. (Fox)



'Incredible': bleached corals thrive within days when touching healthy neighbour

Scientists have made a breakthrough in coral restoration, showing that bleached coral can be rapidly revitalized through contact with a healthy fragment. Rising sea temperatures cause corals to expel symbiotic algae, leading to bleaching and potential starvation. However, researchers have demonstrated that this process can be reversed within days, sparking hope for large-scale solutions. In a controlled experiment, touching coral fragments facilitated algae transfer, enabling quick recovery. Within weeks, bleached coral regained vitality, while separated fragments perished. This "healing touch" method relies on creating a tissue bridge for symbiont transfer, but only among genetically identical coral fragments. While promising, the challenge remains to scale this technique for broader applications in combating coral decline. Marine scientist Stephen Palumbi and his team observed that touching coral fragments allowed symbionts to spread from healthy to bleached coral. Danny Collins, investigating this phenomenon, found that touched fragments recovered within weeks. However, fragments kept apart did not survive. This study offers hope that coral ecosystems can be rescued, but scaling the solution remains a challenge. (Nature)



Jokes

Oxygen, hydrogen, sulfur, sodium, and phosphorus walk into a bar — “OH SNaP!” says the bartender.

Link to previous issues:

Beta Decay

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Spiced Red Sea Bream Tchep

Ingredients

- Red sea bream: 1½ lb (24 oz)
- Basmati rice: 2 cups
- Olive oil: 3 tablespoons
- Black-eyed peas: 1 cup (dried)
- Onion: 1 medium onion
- Tomato: 1½ medium tomatoes (or 2 small tomatoes)
- Bell pepper: 1 medium bell pepper
- Ginger: 1 tablespoon fresh grated ginger
- Garlic: 5 cloves garlic



Instructions

1. Sauté the Aromatics

Heat the olive oil in a large pot or deep pan over medium heat. Add the onion, garlic, and ginger. Cook until the onion becomes soft and translucent, about 10 minutes.

Tip: Do not let the garlic or ginger burn, as this can make the dish bitter.

2. Cook the Vegetables and Peas

Add the tomatoes and bell pepper. Cook until softened, about 5 minutes. Stir in the black-eyed peas and cook for another 5 minutes.

3. Season and Fry the Fish

Season the red sea bream with salt, turmeric, and cumin. In the same pan, fry the fish until golden brown on both sides, about 3 to 4 minutes per side. Remove from the pan and set aside.

Tip: Avoid overcooking the fish so it stays moist and flaky.

4. Cook the Rice

Rinse the basmati rice thoroughly until the water runs clear. Add the rice to the pan. Pour in enough water to cook the rice according to package directions, then bring to a simmer. Cover and cook until the rice is tender and the liquid has been absorbed, about 20 minutes.

Tip: Fluff the rice gently with a fork after cooking to keep the grains separate.

5. Finish the Dish

Place the cooked fish on top of the rice. Cover and let everything steam together for 5 minutes so the flavors can meld.

6. Serve

Garnish with fresh cilantro and serve with lime wedges on the side.